Henri Arno

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Research Profile

PhD candidate at Ghent University working on causal machine learning for data-driven decision support. My research interests include causal inference, treatment effect estimation and policy learning, with applications in business and healthcare.

Education

2021 – present **PhD in Computer Science Engineering and Business Economics**
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Supervisors: prof. Thomas Demeester, prof. Klaas Mulier, and prof. Joke Baeck
Expected completion in Autumn 2026
FWO PhD Fellowship Fundamental Research

2019 **–** 2021 **Master of Science in Business Engineering: Data Analytics**
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Summa cum laude (percentile 95)

2016 **–** 2019 **Bachelor of Science in Business Engineering**
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium

2010 **–** 2016 **Secondary school (Economics-Mathematics)**
RHIZO Lyceum OLV Vlaanderen Kortrijk, Kortrijk, Belgium

Academic Experience

2023 **–** present **PhD Candidate - FWO Fellow**
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Supervisors: prof. Thomas Demeester, prof. Klaas Mulier, and prof. Joke Baeck
Research in causal machine learning for data-driven decision support
Funded by an FWO PhD Fellowship Fundamental Research

Sep **–** Dec 2025 **Visiting Researcher**
Causal Machine Learning Lab, Institute of AI in Management
Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München (LMU), Munich, Germany
Hosted by prof. Stefan Feuerriegel
Funded by an FWO Grant for a Long Stay Abroad

2021 **–** 2023 **Applied ML Research**
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Research on business failure prediction for judicial decision support
Funded through an FWO research project led by prof. Joke Baeck

Research Projects

Causal Machine Learning for Data-Driven Decision Support
Research on treatment effect estimation, ranking, and policy learning from observational data, with applications in business and healthcare.
Selected outputs: International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2026), Machine Learning for Healthcare (MLHC 2026), NeurIPS Causal Representation Learning Workshop (2024).

Business Failure Prediction and Judicial Decision Support
Interdisciplinary research on multimodal business failure prediction and AI-supported decision-making in collaboration with Belgian commercial courts.
Selected outputs: Annals of Operations Research (2025), European Insolvency and Restructuring Journal (2025), FinTech and Natural Language Processing Workshops (2022, 2023).

Grants and Fellowships

2023 – 2027 **FWO PhD Fellowship Fundamental Research**
Research Foundation Flanders (FWO)
Panel: Science and Technology – Computer Science and Information Technology

Sep – Dec 2025 **FWO Grant for a Long Stay Abroad**
Research Foundation Flanders (FWO)
Funding for a three-month research stay at LMU Munich

July 2026 **CWO Faculty Mobility and Sabbatical Fund**
Ghent University, Faculty Committee for Scientific Research (CWO)
Travel support for participation in ICML 2026

Teaching and Supervision

Master's Dissertation Supervision
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Supervised 12 master's dissertations
- 8 students in Business Engineering
- 4 students in Computer Science Engineering

Teaching Assistance
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Assisted with grading, lab sessions, and course-related support for:
- *Machine-Learning Based Natural Language Processing*
- *Topics in Advanced Corporate Finance*
- *Financial Modelling*

Guest Lectures
Ghent University and KU Leuven, Belgium
Delivered guest lectures on AI-related concepts to law students:
Introduction to Artificial Intelligence Technology (KU Leuven)
Law and Economics (Ghent University)

Honours and Distinctions

2017 – 2019 **Quetelet Colleges Honours Programme**
Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium
Selective extracurricular university-wide honours programme

Additional Activities

Vice-President of my local triathlon club (fundraising, website and communications)
Active in long-distance triathlon and endurance sports

Languages

Dutch: native
English: excellent
French: intermediate